NORTHSTAR TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

IT SECURITY POLICY

Requirements for protecting company systems, accounts, devices, networks, and information

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Document Type	POLICY
Access Scope	ALL_EMPLOYEES
Version	1.0
Effective Date	04 November 2026
Policy Owner	IT & Information Security Department
Applies To	All employees of Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
Review Cycle	At least annually and after significant security changes

Fictional demonstration policy for the OnBoardIQ environment. This is a sample policy, not a certification or legal opinion. Technical controls and response procedures should be validated by the company's security and IT owners before real-world use.

1. Purpose

This policy defines the minimum security practices employees must follow when accessing, using, storing, or sharing Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. systems and information. Its objectives are to reduce unauthorized access, prevent data loss, protect business operations, and support timely detection and response to security incidents.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, company-managed devices, company accounts, networks, applications, cloud services, business data, and approved third-party services. It applies whether work is performed from a company office, home, customer site, or another approved location. Contractors and vendors must follow the security requirements included in their agreements and access instructions.

3. Security responsibilities

- **Employees:** Protect credentials and devices, follow approved procedures, complete required training, and report suspected incidents immediately.
- **Managers:** Approve access based on job needs, review access when roles change, and ensure team members understand applicable requirements.
- **IT & Information Security:** Maintain security controls, manage identity and device protections, monitor alerts, investigate incidents, and provide guidance.
- **System and data owners:** Classify information, approve access, define retention needs, and review permissions periodically.

4. Identity and access management

Access must be granted according to job responsibilities and the principle of least privilege. Employees may access only the systems and information required for authorized business work.

- Use an individually assigned company account. Shared accounts are prohibited unless specifically approved and technically controlled by IT.
- Use strong, unique passwords and the company-approved password manager where available.
- Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) on company accounts wherever supported or required.
- Never share passwords, MFA codes, recovery codes, API keys, access tokens, or session cookies.
- Lock your screen whenever leaving a device unattended and sign out of systems when appropriate.
- Request access through the approved process. Do not attempt to bypass access controls or use another person's account.
- Report unexpected MFA prompts, password-reset messages, or suspected account compromise to IT immediately.

5. Acceptable use of devices and software

Company devices and approved software must be used responsibly and kept in a secure condition. Employees must:

- Use company-managed or explicitly approved devices for company work.
- Install operating-system and application updates within the timelines communicated by IT.
- Keep endpoint protection, firewall, device encryption, and other required security controls enabled.
- Install software only from trusted sources and through approved installation or procurement processes.
- Avoid storing company data on personal devices, removable media, or personal cloud accounts unless explicitly approved.
- Not disable security tools, jailbreak or root company devices, or connect unauthorized hardware.
- Report lost, stolen, damaged, or suspected-compromised devices immediately.

6. Email, messaging, and phishing protection

Employees must use approved company communication tools for business information and remain alert to social-engineering attempts. Before opening an attachment, following a link, or responding to an unusual request, verify the sender and context. Treat urgent requests for credentials, payments, gift cards, confidential files, or changes to bank details as suspicious until independently verified.

- Do not share passwords or MFA codes by email, chat, phone, or web form.
- Do not open unexpected attachments or enable macros unless the source and business purpose are verified.
- Report suspicious messages using the company-approved phishing-reporting method or contact the IT Helpdesk.
- Verify sensitive payment or account-change requests using a trusted, separate communication channel.
- Do not forward company information to personal email or unapproved messaging services.

7. Network and remote-work security

Employees working remotely must use approved connectivity and protect information from unauthorized viewing or interception. Use the company VPN or other secure remote-access solution when required. Avoid conducting company work over public or untrusted Wi-Fi unless an approved secure connection is active. Do not bypass network controls or connect unauthorized devices to company networks.

Keep home routers and wireless networks protected with current firmware and strong administrator credentials. Position screens to prevent viewing by unauthorized people, and do not leave company devices unattended in public places or vehicles.

8. Data classification and handling

Company information must be handled according to its sensitivity and approved access permissions. Employees should store business records in approved repositories, share links with the minimum necessary audience, and verify recipients before sending files.

Classification	Examples	Handling expectation
Public	Approved website content, published press releases	May be shared publicly after authorization.
Internal	Internal procedures, team notes, non-public project updates	Share only with employees or approved recipients with a business need.
Confidential	Customer contracts, employee records, financial reports, source code	Restrict access to authorized personnel; use approved encrypted storage and transfer.
Restricted	Credentials, private keys, sensitive personal data, security incident evidence	Strictly limited access; use designated secure systems and never share through unapproved channels.

When in doubt about a document's classification, treat it as confidential until the data owner or IT & Information Security confirms the correct handling.

9. Cloud services, AI tools, and third-party applications

Employees may use only company-approved cloud platforms, SaaS products, integrations, and AI tools for company work. Do not upload confidential, restricted, customer, employee, source-code, or other non-public information to public AI assistants or unapproved external services. Review permissions before connecting applications, granting OAuth access, or sharing cloud folders. Business owners must involve IT and Security before adopting a new service that processes company data.

10. Application, development, and production security

Employees involved in software development or system administration must follow approved secure-development and change-management practices. This includes:

- Store source code in approved repositories and use individual accounts with MFA.
- Never commit passwords, API keys, private keys, tokens, or production secrets to source control.
- Use approved secret-management tools and rotate credentials when exposure is suspected.
- Keep development, testing, and production environments appropriately separated.
- Use synthetic or masked data in development and testing unless access to real data is explicitly approved.
- Require appropriate review and testing before production changes; document approvals and rollback plans.
- Apply security updates and remediate vulnerabilities according to risk-based timelines set by IT & Information Security.

11. Physical security

Employees must prevent unauthorized physical access to offices, devices, and printed information. Wear or display access identification as required, do not lend access cards, challenge or report unescorted visitors where safe, and secure sensitive papers and devices. Confidential material should not be left visible in meeting rooms, shared spaces, or public locations.

12. Backups, retention, and secure disposal

Business data must be stored in approved systems that are covered by company backup and retention arrangements. Employees must not create unofficial archives or retain company data longer than authorized. Paper records, storage media, and devices containing company information must be securely disposed of or returned through IT-approved procedures. Do not independently delete records subject to a legal hold, investigation, or retention requirement.

13. Security incident reporting

A security incident includes suspected or confirmed unauthorized access, phishing compromise, malware, lost devices, accidental disclosure, unusual account activity, exposed credentials, or data sent to the wrong recipient. Report incidents immediately to the IT Helpdesk or IT & Information Security through the designated company channel. If the normal channel is unavailable, notify your manager and use the alternate emergency contact provided during onboarding.

- Report what happened, when it happened, which device or account may be affected, and what information may be involved.
- Do not delete suspicious emails, logs, files, or messages unless instructed by the response team.
- Do not investigate beyond safe initial steps or contact suspected attackers.
- Follow instructions from IT & Information Security, including password resets, device isolation, or access suspension.
- Preserve relevant evidence and cooperate with the incident response process.

14. Monitoring and privacy

To protect company systems, meet legal obligations, and investigate security events, authorized personnel may log and monitor activity on company-managed accounts, devices, networks, and services in accordance with applicable law and company notices. Monitoring access must be limited to legitimate purposes and authorized roles. Employees should have no expectation that company systems are private for personal use beyond rights provided by applicable law.

15. Exceptions and policy violations

Exceptions must be documented, risk-assessed, time-limited where possible, and approved in writing by the designated IT & Information Security authority and relevant data or system owner. Employees must not create informal exceptions or bypass controls. Violations may result in access restriction, corrective action, or disciplinary measures in accordance with company procedures, employment terms, and applicable law.

16. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
All employees	Follow security requirements, protect information and credentials, complete training, and report incidents.
Managers	Approve business access, reinforce policy, and notify IT when staff join, move roles, or leave.
IT & Information Security	Maintain controls, manage incidents, monitor security risks, and review exceptions.
System / data owners	Approve access, classify information, and review permissions and retention needs.
People & Culture	Coordinate onboarding and offboarding notifications and required policy acknowledgements.

17. Policy administration and review

The IT & Information Security Department owns this policy and will review it at least annually, after a significant security incident, or when technology, business, or legal requirements change. Updated versions will be published in the approved document repository and communicated to employees. Questions should be directed to security@northstar.example or the IT Helpdesk through the company service portal.

Employee acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received and read the Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. IT Security Policy (IT-POL-001, Version 1.0). I understand my responsibility to protect company accounts, devices, systems, and information, and to report suspected security incidents promptly.

Employee name: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

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